

Progressing in stages

Involvement in workplace innovation develops in five stages. You can use this model to identify the stage your organization has reached, and what needs to be done to progress toward higher involvement.

1 At level one innovation is random and occasional. People do help to solve problems, but there is no attempt to build on this, and organizations may actively restrict the opportunities for innovation to take place.

2 At level two an organization attempts to mobilize involvement. This needs a formal process for finding and solving problems in a structured and systematic way, and training employees to use it.

3 At level three high-involvement capability is coupled with the strategic goals of the organization, so that improvement activities of teams and individuals can be aligned. Strategy deployment, and monitoring and measuring are required for this.

4 At level four high involvement produces profit. Individuals and groups need to be empowered to innovate on their own initiative. This requires an understanding of, and commitment to, overall strategic objectives.

5 At level five the whole company is involved in experimenting with new ideas and improving processes, in sharing knowledge and creating the complete learning organization.

